

BRITISH COLUMBIA IN A GLOBAL CONTEXT



Geography Open Textbook Collective

Book: British Columbia in a Global Context

This text is disseminated via the Open Education Resource (OER) LibreTexts Project (<https://LibreTexts.org>) and like the thousands of other texts available within this powerful platform, it is freely available for reading, printing, and "consuming."

The LibreTexts mission is to bring together students, faculty, and scholars in a collaborative effort to provide an accessible, and comprehensive platform that empowers our community to develop, curate, adapt, and adopt openly licensed resources and technologies; through these efforts we can reduce the financial burden born from traditional educational resource costs, ensuring education is more accessible for students and communities worldwide.

Most, but not all, pages in the library have licenses that may allow individuals to make changes, save, and print this book. Carefully consult the applicable license(s) before pursuing such effects. Instructors can adopt existing LibreTexts texts or Remix them to quickly build course-specific resources to meet the needs of their students. Unlike traditional textbooks, LibreTexts' web based origins allow powerful integration of advanced features and new technologies to support learning.



LibreTexts is the adaptable, user-friendly non-profit open education resource platform that educators trust for creating, customizing, and sharing accessible, interactive textbooks, adaptive homework, and ancillary materials. We collaborate with individuals and organizations to champion open education initiatives, support institutional publishing programs, drive curriculum development projects, and more.

The LibreTexts libraries are Powered by [NICE CXone Expert](#) and was supported by the Department of Education Open Textbook Pilot Project, the California Education Learning Lab, the UC Davis Office of the Provost, the UC Davis Library, the California State University Affordable Learning Solutions Program, and Merlot. This material is based upon work supported by the National Science Foundation under Grant No. 1246120, 1525057, and 1413739.

Any opinions, findings, and conclusions or recommendations expressed in this material are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily reflect the views of the National Science Foundation nor the US Department of Education.

Have questions or comments? For information about adoptions or adaptations contact info@LibreTexts.org or visit our main website at <https://LibreTexts.org>.

This text was compiled on 06/14/2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Licensing

1: Urban Settlement in British Columbia

- 1.1: Introduction
- 1.2: Urbanization in British Columbia
- 1.3: Case Study 1- The Georgia and Dunsmuir Viaducts
- 1.4: Case Study 2- Dockside Green, Victoria
- 1.5: Summary
- 1.6: Key Terms
- 1.7: Suggested Activities
- 1.8: References and Resources

2: Socio-Economics in British Columbia

- 2.1: Introduction
- 2.2: Quality-of-Life Measures
- 2.3: Homelessness and Poverty in the First World
- 2.4: Case Study 1- Victoria and Williams Lake
- 2.5: Case Study 2- Housing Affordability
- 2.6: Summary
- 2.7: Key Terms
- 2.8: Suggested Activities
- 2.9: References and Resources

3: Aboriginal Issues in British Columbia

- 3.1: Introduction
- 3.2: Territories, Natural Resources and First Treaties
- 3.3: Modern Treaties and Claims
- 3.4: Case Study 1- The Indian Residential School System
- 3.5: Summary
- 3.6: Key Terms
- 3.7: Suggested Activities
- 3.8: References and Resources

4: Resources in British Columbia

- 4.1: Introduction
- 4.2: What are Resources?
- 4.3: Mining in BC
- 4.4: Case Study 1- The Gold Rush
- 4.5: Case Study 2- Carrier Nation and the Endako Mine
- 4.6: Summary
- 4.7: Key Terms
- 4.8: Suggested Activities
- 4.9: References and Resources

5: Food Systems in British Columbia

- 5.1: References and Resources
- 5.2: Introduction
- 5.3: Food Systems in the Physical Landscape
- 5.4: Food Systems in British Columbia
- 5.5: Confronting the Frontiers
- 5.6: Case Study 1- The Agricultural Land Reserve (ALR)
- 5.7: Case Study 2- Managing the BC Salmon Fishery
- 5.8: Summary
- 5.9: Key Terms
- 5.10: Suggested Activities

6: Forestry in British Columbia

- 6.1: Introduction
- 6.2: History of Commercial Logging
- 6.3: Pulp and Paper Mills
- 6.4: Forest Tree Tenures
- 6.5: Case Study 1- Mountain Pine Beetle
- 6.6: Summary
- 6.7: Key Terms
- 6.8: Suggested Activities
- 6.9: References and Resources

7: Health Geography in British Columbia

- 7.1: Introduction
- 7.2: Types of Health Geographies
- 7.3: Case Study 1- The "Golden Hour" and Access to Health Care
- 7.4: Case Study 2- Urban Heat Islands, Health and Spatial Technologies
- 7.5: Summary
- 7.6: Key Terms
- 7.7: Suggested Activities
- 7.8: References and Resources

8: Physical Geography of British Columbia

- 8.1: Suggested Activities
- 8.2: References and Resources
- 8.3: Introduction
- 8.4: Climate Change and Environment in BC
- 8.5: Geology
- 8.6: Hazards
- 8.7: Case Study 1- 1965 Hope Slide
- 8.8: Case Study 2- 1964 Port Alberni Tsunami
- 8.9: Case Study 3- 2003 Okanagan Mountain Park Fire
- 8.10: Summary
- 8.11: Key Terms

Index

[Index](#)

[Glossary](#)

[Detailed Licensing](#)

Licensing LicensingEdit Update titlecancel

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).